transparency



A foreign student's house

Same furniture, not really a different lifestyle, and familiar appliances, perhaps visiting this place is some kind of self-consolation to take out my loneliness or looking for the same emotion as mine.

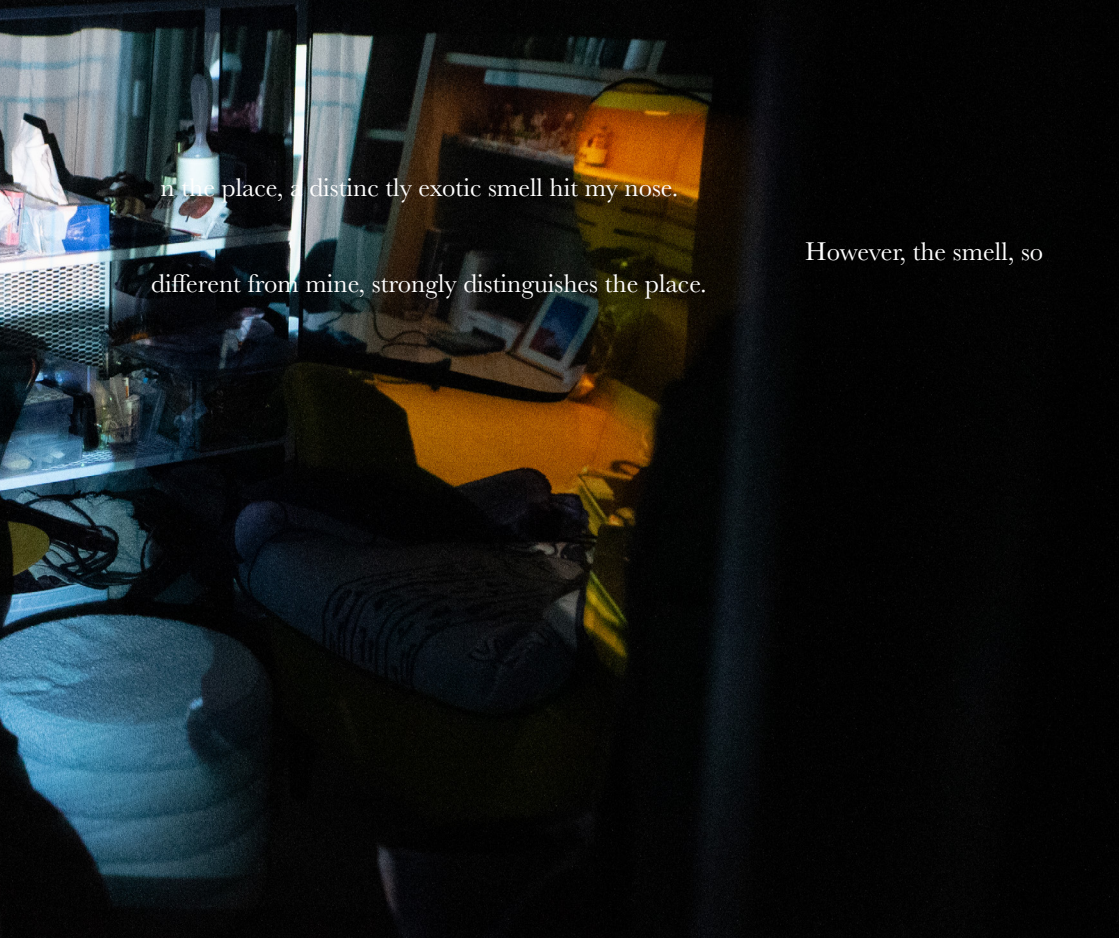
Maybe the randomly arranged white Ikea furniture is a symbol of all of the international students. The same furniture as mine was an element of the place's composition.





I always felt a strange kind of comfort. Actually, it is not just comfort, but rather a sense of kinship.

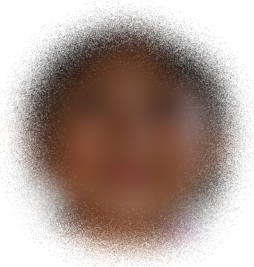
Here I am at Jet's house.



n the place, a distinc tly exotic smell hit my nose.

However, the smell, so different from mine, strongly distinguishes the place.





This is the story of how I almost became my first international lost child.
About ten years ago, I, like many middle-class Koreans, traveled to Southeast Asia for a vacation.
Though nearly a decade has passed, the memory lingers vividly, an indispensable part of my identity.

It was a dark, heavy evening. Despite the word vacation, my parents must have had one of their most exhausting days. After all, a holiday with ten-year-old children is, in truth, not much different from purchasing a form of suffering. Perhaps because of that fatigue, my parents decided to burdens by ease their small children leaving the while. behind for a

It was the kind of time children most love to be afraid of.
"Wait here for just thirty minutes, we'll be back." With that, the two of them left their beloved children by the swimming pool they cherished the most.

Maybe ten minutes passed. As the children sat waiting, a vague fear began to creep in. It was the most primal, childlike fear. Perhaps it came from the unconscious realization that one cannot survive alone. The fear began to take shape. Everything around seemed to edge closer, and the ten-year-old girl thought: before these things engulf me and drag me down into the depths of the water, I must escape.

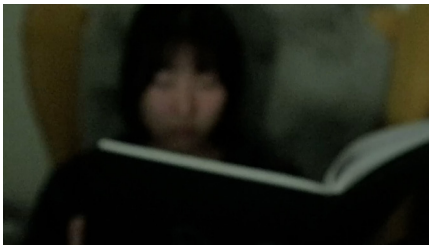
Dragging along her eight-year-old sibling like a sack of luggage, she stumbled toward the hotel reception. And there, in that moment, came her very first words in a foreign language:
"Do you have a hotel map?"
Even if I were to forget everything else, I could never forget that moment—locking eyes with the hotel staff as I spoke those words, and the sight of my younger sibling clinging to an inflatable tube, crying.

Looking back now, that memory has stayed with me powerfully. It reminds me of my inescapable role as the eldest daughter, and of the weight of responsibility I have since placed upon myself.

The Beginning of My Given Identity



The Record of the Thing I Am Not Sure If It Is a Green Onion or a Scallion

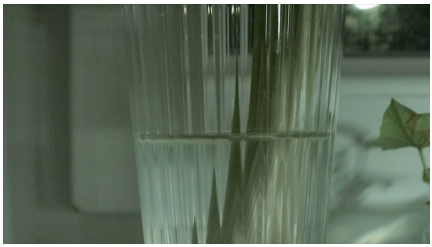




This is my first impression.
A thorn shooting up beside the one that was cut.
Another one, cut off.

The water has turned murky, floating with debris.
Whose debris is this? Whose remnants?

A new, different root grows beside the one that was cut.
Perhaps what emerges is the residue of a desire for nourishment.
A dried branch—or perhaps a stem.







One, two
Three
Four, five
Something stuck—what could it have been?

A familiar smell.
The scent of my stomach.
Perhaps my own scent.
A dried crown of the head.

A side burst open.



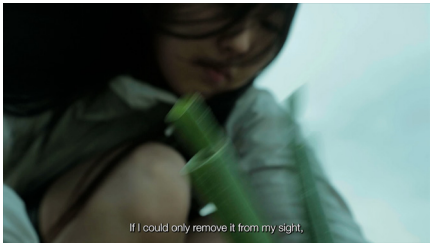


My stolen cup.
The stolen stem of Mr. Scallion.
The stem's whereabouts: the sewage plant.

Or perhaps, my cells.

The cycle of energy.
Stolen solar energy.
Or perhaps, mercy?

A faded tip.
Perhaps its scent.





Where does the green onion end?
The part cut and turned into my cells?
The part cut but never became cells, only excrement?
The stump that remained, cut and left behind?
The part that grows anew?



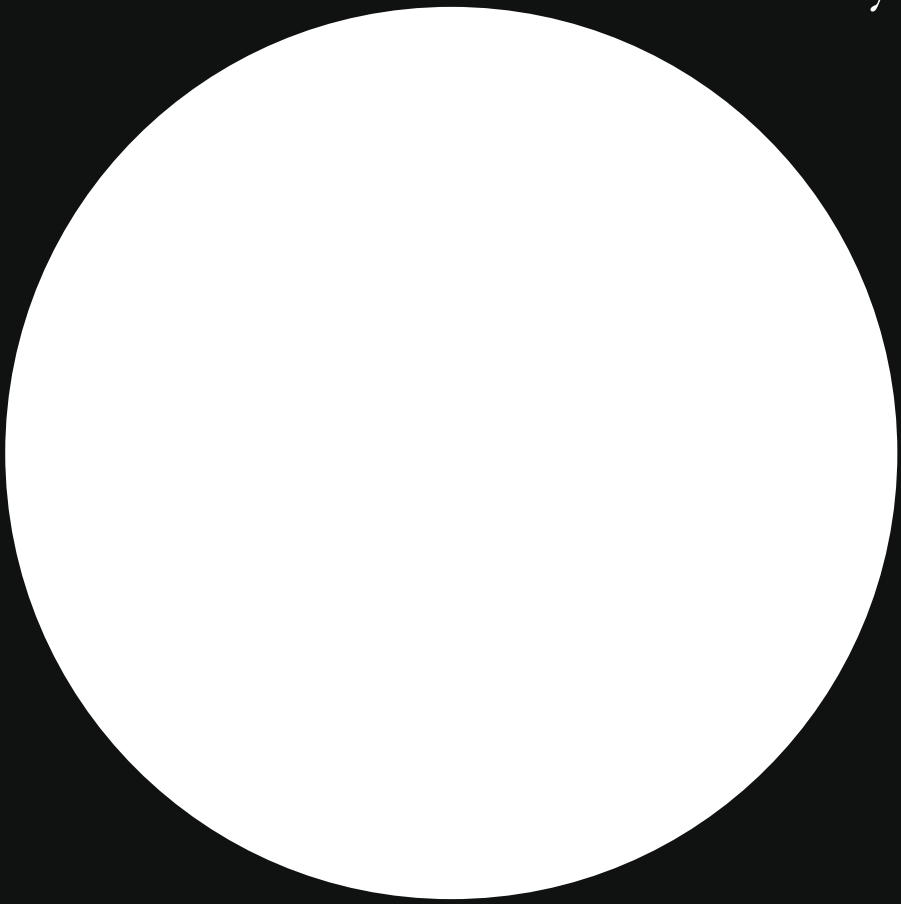




Perhaps all of it is the green onion.

So am I.

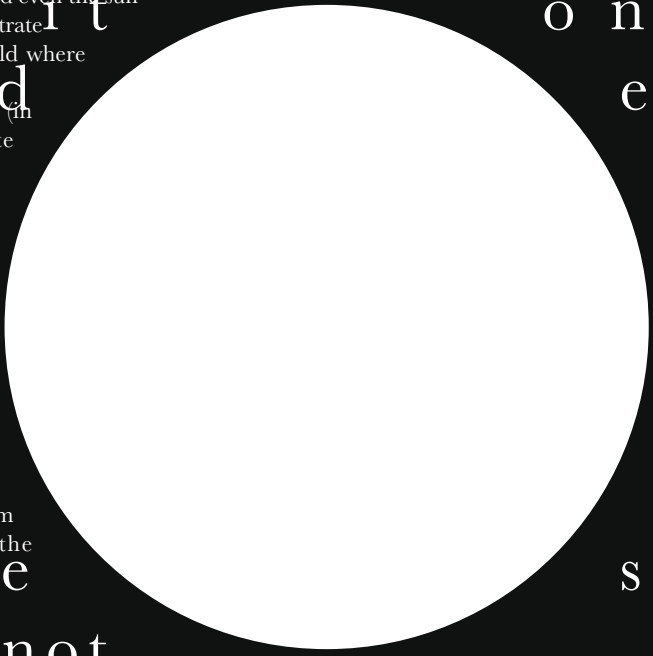
The vast circle above
That was the only



passage
for the light to seep into us.

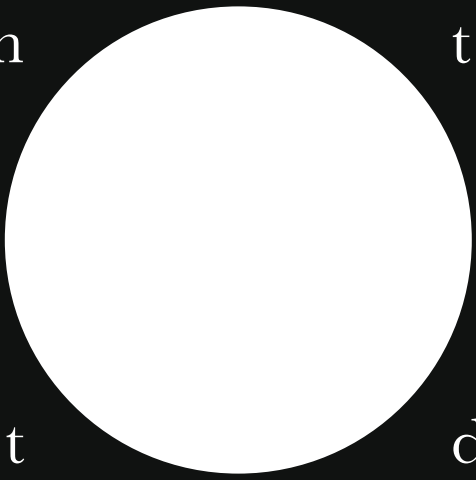
You Throw a Stone
you throw a stone
i throw a stone
i throw a stone
you throw a stone
then a rocket
a rocket comes down
here i lay
next to you
we are
brothers in a way w/o a sky
my father's house is empty your
mother's house has no amber light
as it once had even the sun
cannot penetrate
the open field where
you and i
once played (in
our separate
dreams)
b u r n s &
burns
t h o s e
s t o n e s
w h a t
w e r e
they
w h e r e
did they
come from
Juan Felipe
Herrera from
Notes On the
Assemblage

A dark expanse beyond
as it once had even



the sun
cannot
p e n e t r a t e

In a flash, only once,
when the



deepest dark
aligns with the sun,

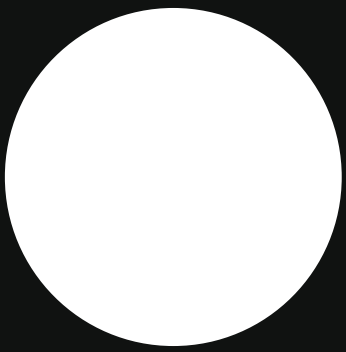
here,
when the deepest dark aligns with the sun,
That moment when our curse started

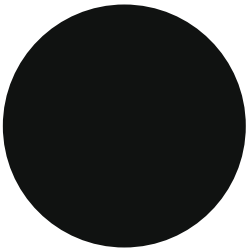
Burning sun.
Burning living thing
This is the result of our sin

Or just a process of resetting the earth
It doesn't die, so we are dying.

Started from the bottom, we are collapsing here

This place
greets a warmth
like a blinding
flash



Commemorating that warmth,
I cower my  small body